

1-3 A Unified Framework

Global business is a vast subject area. It is one of the few courses that will make you appreciate why your university requires you to take a number of seemingly unrelated courses in general education. We will draw on major social sciences, such as economics, geography, history, political

science, psychology, and sociology. We will also draw on a number of business disciplines, such as strategy, finance, and marketing. The study of global business is, thus, quite interdisciplinary. It is easy to lose sight of the “forest” while scrutinizing various “trees” or even “branches.” The subject is not difficult, and most students find it to be fun. The number-one student complaint (based on previous student feedback) is that there is an overwhelming amount of information. Honestly, this is also *my* number-one complaint as your author. You may have to read and learn this material, but I have to bring it all together in a way that makes sense and in a (relatively) compact book that does not go on and on and on for 990 pages.

Learning Objective 1-3

Articulate one fundamental question and two core perspectives in the study of global business.

To make your learning more focused, more manageable, and (hopefully) more fun, in this section—and throughout the book—we will develop a unified framework (shown in [Figure 1.4](#)). This will provide great continuity to facilitate your learning. Specifically, we will discipline ourselves by focusing only on one most fundamental question and two core perspectives. A fundamental question acts to define a field and to orient the attention of students, practitioners, and scholars in a certain direction. Our “big question” is: *What determines the success and failure of firms around the globe?* To answer this question, we will introduce only two core perspectives throughout this book:

- (1) an institution-based view
- (2) a resource-based view

The remainder of this section outlines this framework.

Figure 1.4

A Unified Framework for Global Business

Chapter 1: Globalizing Business: 1-3 A Unified Framework

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